

OPENING IMAGE - CLOSE-UP - SPLIT LIP
INT. SCHOOL COUNSELOR'S OFFICE-
LATE AFTERNOON

ON SCREEN TEXT:
"Sometimes the battles at home echo
louder than the ones outside."

NARRATOR (V.O.)
A tasteful office. Bookshelves
stand tall. Dust caught in amber
light.
Two boys fractured by silence—scars
visible, others not.
Outside: the hum of wealth prowls
in polished engines.
The FIRST TEENAGER sits taut,
designer clothes betraying unrest.
A split lip gleams faintly, swollen
cheek tender.
Across, the SECOND TEENAGER lounges
—puffer jacket, swollen knuckles,
a smirk sharp as glass.
SCHOOL COUNSELOR breathes slow,
weary yet tender.

SECOND TEENAGER (cocky)
You gonna sit there and pretend you
didn't start it?

FIRST TEENAGER (bare, wounded)
I didn't start anything. You know
that.

EXTENDED BREAKDOWN - FACES IN SHADOW

NARRATOR (V.O.)
One wears his bruise like a crown.
The other wears his silence like
shackles.
Between them—a counselor balancing
hope against exhaustion.

SECOND TEENAGER (smug)
Your dad can't buy everything. Not
even forgiveness.

FIRST TEENAGER (quiet, cracking)
He called me a coward.
The word lands heavy. Silence
bruises deeper than fists.

SCHOOL COUNSELOR (gentle)
Names hurt. But hitting isn't the
answer. Who are you trying to prove
yourself to?

FIRST TEENAGER (breaking)
 My mother. If I kept my head down,
 maybe she'd notice.
 The SECOND TEENAGER grins—cruel,
 knowing.

SECOND TEENAGER (leaning in)
 She'd patch the company logo before
 she'd patch you.

ON SCREEN TEXT:
 "Approval is the rarest currency."

DOORWAY - PARENTS ARRIVE
 The MOTHER enters first—immaculate,
 cold, a verdict in heels.
 The FATHER follows, slightly out of
 step—tailored suit, shoulders
 that once built, now burdened by
 distance.

MOTHER (flat)
 This is... unfortunate.
 Her son searches for approval.
 Finds none.

MOTHER (to First)
 Do you understand how this looks?
 Your awards, your future—now small
 print.
 The boy crumples. FATHER steps
 forward, guilt in his eyes.

FATHER (soft)
 I worked so you could choose. Maybe
 I chose wrong. I'm sorry.

FIRST TEENAGER (sharp)
 You were never here.
 The word never cuts deep. The
 FATHER winces, guilt unmasked.

NARRATOR (V.O.)
 Absence is a bruise no one sees.

THE RIVAL'S STING

SECOND TEENAGER (barbed, quiet)
 Funny. My dad says they want to buy
 out what your father built.
 The room stiffens—corporate war
 bleeding into teenage skin.

MOTHER (icy)
 My son's future is paramount.

SCHOOL COUNSELOR (rage, quiet)
 Safety matters more than image.
 (MORE)

SCHOOL COUNSELOR (rage, quiet)
(CONT'D)

The FATHER watches, torn, regret
written in every line.

FATHER (low)
We can't let business dictate their
lives.

NARRATOR (V.O.)
Wealth shields. But it also
suffocates.
Loneliness is louder in polished
halls.
SECOND TEENAGER rises, smirk
lingering.

SECOND TEENAGER (to First)
Tell your dad he's got until
Monday.
The door clicks. Silence blooms.
FINAL IMAGE - HONESTY
The FATHER places a hand on his
son's shoulder—not for show, but to
stay.

FIRST TEENAGER (bare)
I'm tired of pretending money
measures my worth.
I just wanted someone to tell me it
was okay to fail.
The MOTHER's lips part—no words
come.
SCHOOL COUNSELOR closes her file,
steady.

SCHOOL COUNSELOR
Then let's start there. Honesty.
And action.

NARRATOR (V.O.)
Privilege. Absence. Fear. These are
the fractures.
But honesty, even whispered, can
start repair.

ON SCREEN TEXT:
"Between fracture and repair lies
choice."

FADE OUT.